



Belonging

A journaling guide for finding real connection and self-acceptance

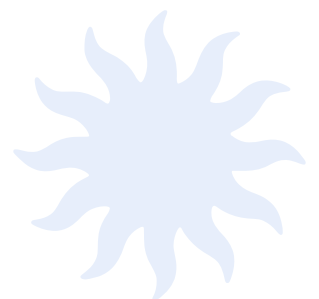
By Hedda Knight

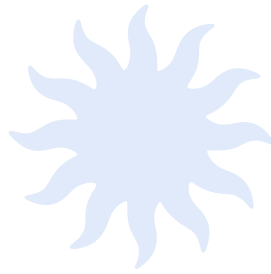
BELONGING

Belonging isn't something you either have or don't — it shows up in specific moments, with specific people, and disappears in others. Most of us are carrying a running story about why we don't fit that we've never actually stopped to question.

This guide invites you to look honestly at when belonging is present and when it isn't, trace the story behind the gap, and find both the practical steps and the internal shift that can close it.

There are no right or wrong answers. Just take your time, write honestly, and notice what comes up.





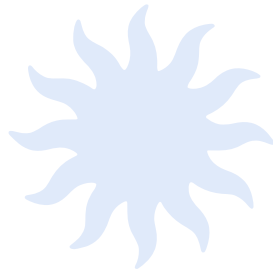
DISCOVERING YOUR SENSE OF BELONGING

1. Think of a time recently you felt like you truly belonged somewhere. Where were you, who were you with, and what made it feel that way?

2. Now think of a place or group where you often feel like you don't belong. What specifically makes it feel that way?

3. Is there a pattern in the places or people where you feel most yourself, versus the ones where you don't?

4. What do you tend to do when you feel like you don't belong — shrink, perform, leave early, overcompensate?



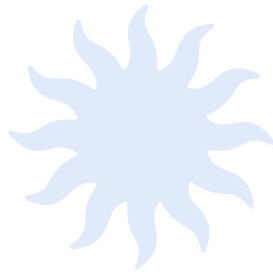
GETTING CLEARER

1. What is the exact story you tell yourself about why you don't belong? Write it word for word, as it sounds in your head.

2. Where did that story come from — a specific memory, a person, a pattern you noticed young?

3. Is that story actually true right now, or is it an old conclusion you've kept applying to new situations?

4. What would you have to believe about yourself for that story to stop deciding how you show up?



BRINGING IT TO LIFE

1. What is one small, real step you could take this week to build more genuine connection or community — reaching out, showing up, joining something?

2. What is one way you're different from the people or spaces around you that you've been treating as a flaw, rather than just a fact about you?

3. What would it look like to belong to yourself first — to feel at home in who you are, regardless of the room you're in?



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